

Safeguarding, boundaries and lone working

Both professions and duty managers | Original draft for review

Named responsibility

Appoint a safeguarding lead [NAME/CONTACT] and deputy [NAME/CONTACT], plus an out-of-hours route. Staff must know whom to contact and when external help is necessary. A cleaning or beauty booking does not make a provider a carer, babysitter or investigator. Do not assume the presence of a child or vulnerable adult automatically authorises specialist work or a particular DBS level.

Recognise and respond

Concerns can include physical harm, threats, coercion, sexual abuse, neglect or financial exploitation. Record what you actually observe and what is said, separating facts from interpretation. Listen calmly; do not interrogate, investigate privately, promise secrecy or confront a suspected abuser. Explain that information may need to be shared with people who can help.

For immediate danger or an emergency crime, call 999 and move to safety if possible. Non-immediate safeguarding concerns should go promptly to the lead and the appropriate local authority safeguarding service or police as needed. Internal permission must not delay urgent protection. For children, contact the relevant children's social care route; follow the correct local procedures for the nation and location involved.

Sharing and recording

Use the secure incident route, with time, location, people involved, exact relevant words and actions taken. Share only relevant information with those who need it. Seek advice on consent and lawful sharing; do not treat consent as always necessary or always irrelevant. Protect the person from further exposure and restrict access to the report. The lead must record referral decisions, rationale, follow-up and any protective booking restriction.

Lone-working arrangements

Before a visit, confirm the address, access arrangements, known risks, charged phone and an agreed check-in/check-out plan. A named person must be able to respond if contact is missed; an unattended app notification is not an emergency response service. OWNER DECISION: approve actual contact intervals, escalation delays, on-call cover and emergency procedure before launch.

If threatened or unsafe, leave when possible, avoid confrontation and contact help. Do not remain to protect a rating or finish photographs. Never enter an unassessed confined space or attempt an unsafe rescue. Travel plans should allow realistic time; do not use a phone while driving. Consider accessibility and individual circumstances in the risk assessment without discriminatory assumptions.

Missed check-in procedure

The duty contact checks the schedule and attempts approved contact. If there are indicators of immediate danger, contact emergency services without waiting for routine intervals. Otherwise follow the approved escalation plan, sharing only necessary location and contact information. Record each action and outcome; close the incident only when safety is established. Test this process with staff before using it for live visits.

Concern record

Reporter/contact: _____ Date/time/location: _____ Immediate safety action: _____

Observed facts and relevant words: _____ Persons at risk: _____

Lead/external service contacted and reference: _____ Information shared/reason: _____

Restrictions/follow-up owner: _____ Review date/outcome: _____

Sources

HSE lone-working guidance: <https://www.hse.gov.uk/lone-working/employer/> Reporting child abuse:

<https://www.gov.uk/report-child-abuse-to-local-council> Reporting adult abuse:

<https://www.gov.uk/report-abuse-of-older-person> Emergency crime reporting: <https://www.gov.uk/report-crime>